

NHSA 103 Understanding Human Behaviour

Instructions

1. All the questions are compulsory
2. Marks are indicated against each question. Total Marks is 40
3. There are four parts (A, B, C, D). All parts need to be answered separately. Start each part from a fresh page
4. If a question mentions word limit, it must be followed
5. Time limit is 2 hours

Part A: 10 marks

1) Mark is a 25-year-old who recently started a new job. He has a habit of impulsively buying gadgets and clothes—even when he does not really need them. When Mark makes these purchases, he feels an immediate rush of pleasure and excitement. However, shortly after, he experiences intense guilt and worry about the money he spent, reflecting an internalized moral standard. To ease this discomfort, Mark tells himself that these items will improve his mood and even help him in his career, which is his way of balancing his urges with reality.

Last week, while shopping online, Mark encountered a “once in a lifetime” discount offer on a gadget he never planned to buy. Even though he knew it wasn’t necessary, he justified the purchase by thinking it would “change his life,” using a specific way to protect himself from the guilt of overspending. Additionally, Mark’s impulsivity not only drives his quick-thrill shopping but also undermines his ability to invest the time and emotional energy needed to form and maintain deep personal relationships

- a) When Mark sees the “once in a lifetime” discount offer on a gadget he does not need, he convinces himself that the purchase is essential for his success. Identify and define the defense mechanism he is using in this situation. (2 marks)
- b) Based on Mark’s age and the details provided in the story, which stage of Erikson’s psychosocial development is he most likely experiencing? What is the primary developmental need or conflict of that stage? (2 marks)
- c) Considering Mark’s behaviour as described in the story, which trait(s) from the OCEAN model seem most evident in him? How might these traits influence his impulsive spending and difficulties in forming intimate relationships? (2 marks)

2) Identify which psychosocial stage is similar to the incongruence of Real and Ideal Self, and describe how the respective **task/conflict** of the identified psychosocial stage helps in finding the **congruence** between Real and Ideal Self? (1+3 marks; write not more than 150 words).

Part B Total: 10 marks

1. Suppose you have developed a product, how do you think you can use any two compliance techniques to ensure a maximum reach among the audience? (6 marks)
2. How do you think the illusion of morality and group polarization affect group decision making? (4 marks)

Part C: 10 marks

1. What are categories and concepts? Why do we need concepts? (2 marks)
2. List the influences of typicality on cognition. (2 marks)
3. What is the main difference between "Prototype theory" and "Exemplar theory"? (1 mark)
4. An online store lists a smart watch with an "original price" of ₹15,000 but offers it at a "discounted price" of ₹7,500. Even if similar smart watches are available for ₹7,000 elsewhere, customers perceive this as a great deal. Identify the cognitive bias in the above situation (1 mark) and explain (1 mark).
5. Answer the following:
 - a) Explain the sunk cost fallacy. (1 mark)
 - b) Identify two psychological factors that contribute to the sunk cost fallacy. (1 mark)
6. What is confirmation bias? (1 mark)

Part D Total: 10 marks

1. A pet trainer taught a dog to run towards a thrown object when the word "Fetch" is called. He used classical conditioning for the training. Identify the UCS, CS, UCR, CR. [2 marks]
2. Ravi, a 10-year-old boy, had to visit the hospital for an injection, an experience he found extremely painful and frightening. The doctor who administered the shot was wearing a white coat, and ever since that day, Ravi felt uneasy whenever he saw someone dressed the same way. On subsequent visits, just seeing the hospital building from a distance made his heart race, even before stepping inside. Over time, as he waited in the reception area during check-ups, he remained calm till the sound of the receptionist's voice calling out names started making him anxious, though he didn't know why. Using your knowledge of higher order conditioning, identify the chain of conditioning by mentioning all the UCS and CSs. [3 Marks]
3. What is the main difference between classical conditioning and operant conditioning? Give one example for each [2 marks]
4. A teenager gets a new alarm clock that makes a loud beeping sound every morning. The sound is jarring and unpleasant, making them feel annoyed and groggy as they wake up. After a few weeks, they start feeling annoyed and uneasy just by seeing the alarm clock, even when it's not making any noise. What type of learning is taking place in this scenario? Explain the process by identifying the key elements involved in the development of this response. [1 + 2 = 3 Marks]